Antiagreement is Syntactic: Evidence from South Sulawesi

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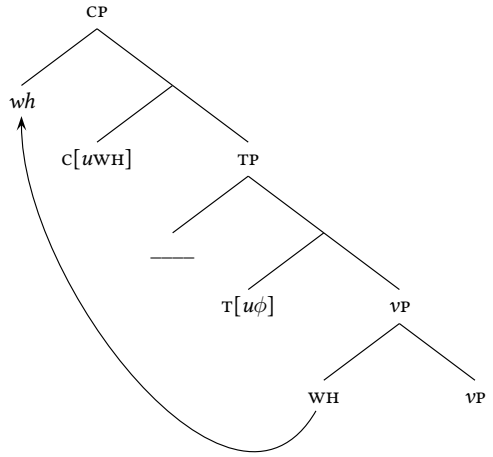
1 Two Approaches to Antiagreement

- Definition: **Antiagreement**
  - An instance of ϕ-agreement X shows an *A'-Sensitivity Effect* (Baier 2018) if:
    1. X takes the form α for the set of ϕ-features F on a goal G when G remains in-situ, and
    2. X takes the form β for F when G undergoes A'-movement, where $\alpha \neq \beta$.
  - Central Question: is there anything syntactic to antiagreement?

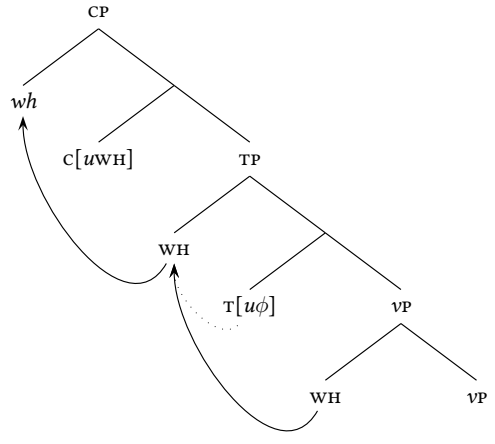
1. The Syntactic Approach — Brandi & Cordin 1989
   - Observation: antiagreement typically arises with subject agreement. — Ouhalla 1993
   - Connection: cross-linguistic difficulties behind subject extraction. — Chomksy 1981, Rizzi 2006
   - Proposal: antiagreement arises when extracting arguments *skip* canonical subject position.
     - Movement constraints block direct extraction from the projection linked to subject agreement.
     - One implementation: antilocality blocks movement from spec,tp/topP/subjP to spec,CP.
       - A'-moved subjects cannot pass through spec,tp; move to spec,cp from a lower position.
       - result: Antiagreement, if agreement parasitic on movement. — Hornstein 2009; Erlewine 2020
     - Alternatives: ecp-effects, Criterial Freezing — Ouhalla 1993, Phillips 1997, Shlonsky 2014
   - key claim: antiagreement involves extraction which *skips* subject positions.

2. The Morphological Approach — Baier 2018
   - **Claim**: antiagreement not strictly linked to subject extraction.
     - Selayarese (South Sulawesi, Austronesian): objects trigger antiagreement; subject position irrelevant
     - **Implication**: antiagreement cannot be linked to problems with subject extraction; something else.
   - Proposal: Antiagreement arises through constraints on the spell-out of agreement.
     - Probes regularly copy back all the features from the goals with which they interact. — Deal 2015b
     - issue: Certain probes cannot spell out the combination of regular ϕ-features and wh, foc, rel.
     - resolution: post-syntactic impoverishment rules apply; delete ϕ-features on these probes.
   - key claim: antiagreement arises outside the narrow syntax.

(1) *Syntactic Approach: Skipping*



(2) *Morphological Approach: no Skipping*



1.1 Mandar Antiagreement

- Mandar: South Sulawesi, Austronesian; closely related to **Selayarese**. Grimes & Grimes 1987
- Verb-initial; no morphological case; ERG-ABS agreement; WH-words & FOCI in the left periphery.
- ANTIAGREEMENT: ABS agreement cannot index A'-moved elements (3c).[1]

(3) *Mandar: Agreement and Antiagreement*

a. Maq-ellong=**i** *pro* diong.
INTR-sing=3.ABS 3 there
'He's singing there.'

b. **Mu**-ita=**i** iting a?
2.ERG-see=3.ABS that Q
'You saw that guy, huh?'

c. Innai mu-ita(=***i**)?
who 2.ERG-see=3.ABS
'Who did you see?'

- Three claims:
  1. Agreement linked to distinct subject position; *pace* work on Selayarese (Béjar 1999, Baier 2018).
  2. Antiagreement *can* be linked to independent constraints on subject extraction.
  3. Quantifier float patterns: independent evidence for '*skipping*' in subject extraction.

2 Antiagreement arises only with Subjects

2.1 Absolutive Enclitics = Agreement

- ABS enclitics reflect agreement. *pace* Billings & Kaufman 2004
- Four diagnostics:
  1. COARSENESS (Preminger 2011): CD indexes all features of its associate; AGR may not.
  2. REFERENTIALITY (Baker & Kramer 2016): CD cannot target non-referential goals; AGR may.
  3. TENSE-VARIANCE (Nevins 2011): CD shows no variance in form across tenses; AGR may.
  4. SECOND-POSITION (Franks & King 2000, Bošković 2016): doubled clitics never surface in 2P.
- ABS clitics pattern with agreement across the board.
  1. NOT COARSE: ABS enclitics index only person, not number. Kaufman 2008
  2. NO REFERENTIALITY REQUIREMENT: ABS enclitics target anaphors. Finer 1997
  3. TENSE-VARIANT: distinct subjunctive forms. Sirk 1996; Zobel 2002
  4. SECOND-POSITION: ABS appears in 2P. Campbell 1989

Table 1: Mandar ABS is Agreement

TEST	CD	AGR	ABS	SOURCE
INDEXES ALL FEATURES ON GOAL?	✓	✘	✘	Preminger (2011)
TARGETS ONLY REFERENTIAL GOALS?	✓	✘	✘	Baker & Kramer (2016)
SHOWS TENSE-VARIANT FORMS?	✘	✓	✓	Nevins (2011)
CAN SURFACE IN SECOND-POSITION?	✘	✓	✓	Franks & King (2000)

[1] Mandar data presented here have been collected over 2 years of fieldwork and ten months in Indonesia. All judgments checked with two long-term (2018-) consultants. Abbreviations: ABS: absolutive, ERG: ergative, GEN: genitive, NEG: negation, INTR: intransitive, PFV: perfective

2.2 Agreement on T

1. LINEAR POSITION: ABS clitics high in the middle field.
   - Follows first element: NEG > ASP > MODAL > MOTION > V
   - No climbing past NEG: *temporal adverbs, *complementizers
2. DISTRIBUTION: finite clauses only.

(4) *ABS second-position in TP; finite clauses only*

a. Mau tulu indang=**o** u-ita,
Although always NEG=2.ABS 1.ERG-see
'Although I always don't see you.'

b. Na-tumae-**mu/*o**, sumangiq=o?
3.ERG-propose-2.GEN/2.ABS cry=2.ABS
'When he proposed to you, you cried?'

- **Claim**: ABS in T; HIGH-ABS Coon et al. 2014

2.3 Absolutives Move to Subject Position

- The ABS argument = the subject Schachter 1996

1. A'-extraction: ABS only Keenan 1972
   - 'Highest-only restriction'; typical analysis involves intervention-based locality Aldridge 2004

(5) *Only Absolutives Extract*

a. Na-ita=aq kamaq *pro*.
3.ERG-see=1.ABS dad
'Dad saw me.'

b. **Innai** na-ita kamaq?
who 3.ERG-see dad
'Who did dad see?'

c. ***Innai** na-ita=aq?
who 3.ERG-see=1.ABS
INT: 'Who saw me?'

2. Binding: ABS > ERG.
   - Condition-A anaphors can be ERG; bound by ABS Cole & Hermon 2008
   - Quantified ABS object can bind possessor of ERG; no WCO even with extraction
   - CF: Tagalog (Richards 2000), Malagasy (Pearson 2001), Atayal (Huang & Lin 2012), Malay (Kaufman 2018),
   - Analysis: O shifts above A, then moves to subject position Rackowski 2002

(6) *Absolutive O binds into Agent; no WCO*

a. *Maq-ellong=i **alawe-na**.
INTR-sing=3.ABS self-3.GEN
INT: 'Himself is singing.'

b. Na-ita=i **alawe-na** i=Adi.
3-see=3 self-3 NAME
'Himself$_i$ saw Adi$_i$.'

c. **Innai**$_i$ na-salili kindo'-**na**$_i$?
who 3-miss mom-3
'Who$_i$ does his$_i$ mom miss?'

2.4 Antiagreement Implicates the Subject Position

- The Absolutive moves to a position above the agent.
  1. Extraction restriction: ABS > ERG
  2. Binding facts: ABS > ERG
  3. ABS arguments float quantifiers; ERG cannot.
- RESULT: Mandar antiagreement makes reference to a *position*.
  - Antiagreement arises only with absolutive arguments; these move into a subject position.
  - **Result**: the effect can be linked to syntactic position; impoverishment not necessary.
  - *Pace* the morphological alternative: absolutive objects do not move Selayarese: Baier 2018

3 Antiagreement via Skipping

3.1 Quantifier Float

- Mandar quantifiers: DP-internal or preverbal.

(7) *Mandar Quantifiers: DP-Internal or Preverbal*

a. Mambaca=i **inggana-na** sola-u.
read=3.ABS all-3.GEN friend-1.GEN
'All my friends are reading.'

b. **Inggana-na** pole=i sola-u.
all-3.GEN come=3.ABS friend-1.GEN
'All my friends came.'

- Preverbal quantifiers in subject position:
  - Linear position: identical to ABS agreement.
    - Follows complementizers, adverbs; precedes NEG, ASP, MODALS, V
  - Strictly associates with the ABS argument.

(8) *Preverbal Quantifiers at the left edge of the middle field*

a. Sangnging **indang**=i me-cawa tomeqoro.
all NEG=3 INTR-laugh attendant
'All of the people attending didn't laugh.'

b. **Mau tulu** sangnging me-cawa=i,
although always all INTR-laugh=3
'Although they all always laugh,'

- **Proposal**: preverbal quantifiers reach their surface position via stranding.
  - The subject moves to SPEC,TP; triggers ABS agreement; Q moves within the DP
  - The subject and quantifier get spelled out discontiguously Fanselow and Ćavar 2001; Doliana 2020
    - CF: subjects undergo postsyntactic postposing in Austronesian. Chung 1990, Sabbagh 2014

(9) *Two Quantifier Positions*

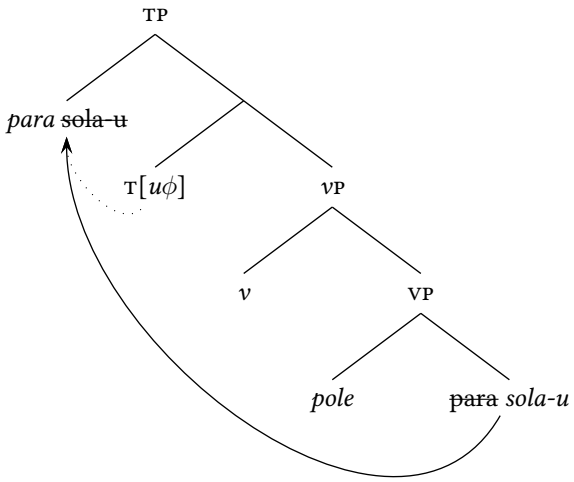
a. Pole=m=i **inggana-na** sola-u.
come=PFV=3 all-3.GEN friend-1.GEN
My friends all came.

b. **Inggana-na** pole=m=i sola-u.
all-3.GEN come=PFV=3 friend-1.GEN
'My friends all came.'

c. **Inggana-na** sola-u pole.
all-3.GEN friend-1.GEN come
'My friends all came.'

d. Para pole=m=i sola-u
each come=PFV=3 friend-1.GEN
'My friends each came.'

(10) *Quantifier Float via Scattered Deletion*



- **Prediction**: no floated quantifiers linked to anything outside subject position.

3.2 Quantifier Float and Extraction

- The arguments which do not trigger ABS cannot float quantifiers.
  - The transitive agent and antipassive object: cannot associate with the FQ. Donohue 2004
  - The A'-extracted elements which trigger antiagreement: cannot float quantifiers either.
- **Claim**: these things never occupy subject position.

(11) *Tr. Agent, A'-Moved Subject cannot float Q*

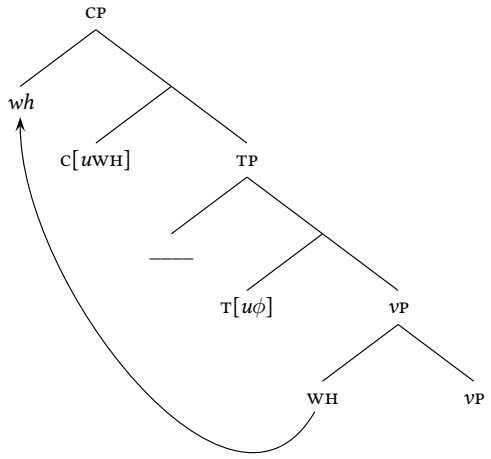
a. Sangnging na-oloqi=i iting k-drama.
all 3-like=3 that k-drama
'She likes all those k-dramas.'
NOT: 'they all like…'

b. *Innai **sangnging** mang-uma?
who all INTR-farm
INT: 'Who all farms?'

c. *Sola-u **sangnging** maq-alli bau.
friend-1.GEN all INTR-buy fish
INT: 'My friends all bought fish.'

d. *Ia iting tauq **sangnging** mongeq.
those.are person all sick
INT: 'Those are the ones who are all sick.'

(12) *A'-Arguments cannot float Q; Skip Subject Position*



4 Conclusions

1. Mandar shows an anti-agreement effect: A'-extraction makes ABS disappear.
2. Antiagreement must be linked to a distinct subject position (*pace* Baier 2018)
   - Antiagreement arises only with absolutive agreement in T.
   - Absolutives bind into ergatives; show extraction privilege; can float quantifiers.
   - CLAIM: the absolutive typically moves to a subject position.
3. Antiagreement correlates with syntactic properties which may suggest skipping.
   - Absolutive arguments float quantifiers to a preverbal subject position.
   - The arguments which trigger antiagreement cannot float quantifiers.
   - **Claim**: the arguments which trigger antiagreement *skip* subject position.

RESULT: Antiagreement is syntactic in Mandar.

- The pattern makes strict reference to a structural position.
- Extracting arguments show signs of not passing through this position.
- The latter pattern cannot be derived on a purely morphological approach to antiagreement.

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